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NETC 280 – IT Documentation

Lab 6 – Writing a Standard Operating Procedure

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Part 2

- 1. Look at the header block at the top of the Appendix C SOP. List at least four pieces of information that appear there and explain in one sentence why each one matters for document control.**

Five key pieces of information within the header block of Appendix C contains a title, a date, an SOP number, a page number, and an author with some departmental acronyms (EMB/ESAD). Each of these is an important piece of information about the SOP.

The **title** helps set the scope of the appendix and directly states what the SOP is about.

The **date** indicates when the SOP was created, which will give context as to whether the SOP is current, outdated, or might be in need of updating.

The **SOP number** indicate an important designation within the organization to help identify the SOP and make it easy to use as a reference (many other SOPs are referred to in the document by their number).

The **page number**, which carries on throughout the appendix, indicates how many pages to expect in the SOP and what order they come in – further clarifying what the reader should expect from the SOP.

The **author** and **departmental acronyms** indicate the person and organizations (in this context, the Environmental Monitoring Branch [EMB] and the Environmental Science and Assessment Division [ESAD] of the Environmental Protection Agency [EPA]) that authored the document and therefore own the SOP.

- 2. The SOP includes a Health and Safety section before the procedure steps begin. Why do you think this section appears where it does rather than at the end of the document?**

Given the topic (how to collect wastewater samples), it is of vital importance that the proper safety precautions be taken by those collecting the samples. This is why the Health and Safety section appears before the procedural steps are listed. The author wants to ensure that the health and safety measures are taken BEFORE any collection happens.

- 3. Find one step in the procedure that includes a conditional instruction, aka a step that says to do something different depending on the situation. Write the step number and describe in your own words what decision the performer has to make at that point.**

Step 8 indicates that if specific conditions prevent the sampler to use their own equipment, they may use the facility's equipment so long as it meets the approval of the inspector. The

sampler must make a determination that their equipment cannot be used in this instance, that the facility's equipment would be able to be used, and must get approval from the inspector that the borrowed equipment is adequate.

- 4. The EPA guidance states that SOPs should be written in the active voice, present tense, with "you" implied rather than written. For example, "Collect the sample" not "The technician should collect the sample." Find one step in Appendix C that follows this guideline well. Write the step number and explain briefly why it works.**

Step 7.b.2 states "For oil and grease, use a single length or double length pole sampler for immersing the glass bottle into the wastewater."

The step is clear: it tells the sampler what tool to use and how to use it. It leaves no ambiguity as to what the action is supposed to be and assumes the reader is doing the action (NDPES inspectors, according to section G).

- 5. Appendix C ends with a References section. Why is it important for an SOP to cite its sources? Describe one realistic scenario where an outdated reference could cause a real-world problem.**

It's important for the SOP to cite its sources because the material it draws from can be verified. It also gives the reader an opportunity to learn more about the SOP or how it fits into a bigger system, as is the case with this SOP. An outdated reference could cause a problem in this particular SOP if a new, stricter law was passed that had additional requirements for sampling inspections that are not immediately included in, say SOP 2332.2 2 (referenced in the first paragraph of Section I – Procedural steps. With outdated information, samples collected after the passing of the law would not conform to it. This would cost time and money, as samples would have to be collected in the correct manner, effectively doubling the work performed.

Part 4

SOP Template — Complete all sections:

SOP Title:	Re-imaging a Windows computer with a USB boot drive (full wipe)	SOP ID #:	IT-001
Author:	Juan Pablo de Legarreta	Version:	1.0
Date:	03/26/2026	Review Date:	03/26/2027
Approved By:	Professor Phillip Haller	Classification:	Internal - IT
1. Purpose			
This is a step-by-step procedure for re-imaging a computer (full wipe) with the Windows operating system using a designated USB boot drive.			
2. Scope			
This procedure is for L1 Help Desk Analysts tasked with re-imaging laptops or desktop machines running a version of Windows. This procedure does not apply to servers or endpoints that use a non-Windows operating system. This procedure also is not for partial resets or updating operating systems. It is only for full-wipe resets.			
3. Roles and Responsibilities			
Role / Title	Responsibility		
L1 Help Desk Analyst	Re-image target device.		
L2 Help Desk Analyst	Troubleshoot escalated target devices.		
Help Desk Manager	Sign off on completed re-imaged target devices.		
4. Prerequisites / Required Resources			
1. USB flash drive with bootable image of Windows 11 (.ISO file) 2. Target device(s) to re-image			
5. Procedure Steps (Note: The number of your steps may or may not be 7, this is just a template)			
Step #	Action	Performed By / Notes	
1	Power down target device.		
2	Connect the flash drive to an open USB port on the target device.		
3	Power on the target device.	Do step 4 IMMEDIATELY after powering on the target device!	

4	Press the boot-device selection key on the target device (usually F2, F10, F12, or Esc).	If the expected keys do not work, look up the device's boot-device selection menu key online, power down the device, and try step 3 again.
5	Click 'Next' on the Windows Set Up menu.	The default settings do not need to be changed.
6	Click 'Install'.	
7	Check the 'I accept the license terms' box.	
8	Select 'Custom: Install Windows Only'	
9	Verify the ticket or manager's instructions to ensure that the target device can be fully wiped.	If the target device requires a partial reset, stop and continue using SOP IT-002.
10	Delete any partitions and drives except 'Drive 0 Unallocated Space'.	
11	Click 'Next.'	
12	Wait until the installation is complete.	Installation usually takes 4-15 minutes.
13	Power off the device when the 'Select Region' screen appears.	The target device is ready to be used now.
6. Exceptions and Escalation		
If the reimage fails at any step, attempt the process again. If it fails a second time, escalate to L2 Help Desk Analyst.		
7. Verification / Sign-Off		
After a successful reimage, update the ticket as completed and set device aside for storage. Once all devices are completed or properly escalated, contact Help Desk Manager for verification and sign-off.		

Part 5

- 6. Compare your SOP to Appendix C. What structural elements did you include that the EPA example also used? Was there anything in the EPA example that you chose not to include, or couldn't apply to your topic? Explain.**

Appendix C is organized differently than the table provided for this SOP. However, several elements are included in both, such as a section to describe the SOP's purpose, scope, equipment and supplies, the procedural steps, and references.

There were several elements that Appendix C contained that were not necessary for this SOP, such as a Table of Contents, since this SOP was much smaller in scope. It also had no Cautions or Health and Safety warnings, as the topic of this SOP does not include inherent dangers to health or safety.

- 7. You were required to write steps in the active voice. How did that constraint affect how you wrote your procedure? Give a specific example of a step you rewrote or almost wrote incorrectly.**

The constraint mostly came up on step 9/10. At first, I wrote "Make sure that the device is authorized to be fully wiped before doing this step" in the 'Notes' part of 'Delete any partitions and drives except Drive 0'. I decided that it was more important to verify first, so I split them into two steps (9 and 10), and decided to use the word 'Verify' instead of 'make sure... is authorized' to ensure that the verification takes place.

- 8. Imagine a brand-new employee is following your SOP on their first day. Identify one step in your procedure where they might get confused or stuck, and describe how you would revise that step to make it clearer.**

Steps 5-12 were written as I watched someone go through the process on YouTube. I tried to make them as simple as possible and in the sequence that I saw them in. If the process goes exactly like I saw on the video, the instructions will reflect what the employee sees. However, to clarify the steps, I would prefer to include screenshots so the person following along could see in the SOP what they're expected to see on the screen.

- 9. SOPs need to be updated when things change. Pick one step from your procedure and describe a realistic event — a software update, a policy change, a hardware replacement — that would require that step to be revised. What should the revision process look like?**

Steps 5-12 assume a Windows 11 boot is being utilized. If the menus or order change with a new distribution of Windows, they would have to be changed. The revision would require the owner of the SOP to go through the process and update the steps to reflect the new menus and selections on the new OS.

Sources

Thepcphone. "How to Get into BIOS & Enable USB Boot for Microsoft Surface Book 2." *YouTube*, 23 Nov. 2024, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sF1lx4Y_Muo. Accessed 30 Mar. 2026.

Windows Hardware Developer. "Install Windows from a USB Flash Drive." *Learn.microsoft.com*, 14 June 2023, <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows-hardware/manufacture/desktop/install-windows-from-a-usb-flash-drive?view=windows-11>.